

Bye-Bye, Flat Bum? New Drug Might Help Keep Muscles Strong While Losing Weight

From: BBC News Mined: 2026-06-08 3 min read

Have you heard of medicines like Ozempic or Wegovy? They help people lose weight by making them feel less hungry. But here's a weird **side effect**: some people lose muscle too, which can make their bottoms look flat or saggy. Some call it "Ozempic butt." Yikes! Now, scientists might have a fix. A new drug called **apitegromab** (say: ap-ih-teg-roe-mab) could help. In a study with 102 adults, people who took **apitegromab** along with their weight-loss shot kept more muscle while still losing fat. Body scans proved it! The drug works by blocking a **protein** that breaks down muscle. But don't rush to the doctor yet—it's only available in tests, and you have to get it through an **IV drip**. The company hopes to make an **injection pen** someday, like the weight-loss shots. Experts say we need bigger studies to be sure it's safe and really works. In the meantime, if you're on these meds, doctors already say to eat healthy and do **strength training** like push-ups or lifting weights to protect your muscles. And remember, these drugs aren't for a quick slim-down before the beach; they're serious medicine. Still, it's cool to think science might help people get healthier without losing their strength!

Word Treasure

side effect -- An unwanted change that happens when you take a medicine.

apitegromab -- A new drug being tested to help keep muscles strong while losing weight.

protein -- A tiny building block in the body that, when blocked, can stop muscle from breaking down.

IV drip -- A way to give medicine through a thin tube directly into a vein.

injection pen -- A small, easy-to-use device that gives a shot without a big needle stick.

strength training -- Exercises like push-ups or lifting weights that build strong muscles.

Background you need

Ozempic and Wegovy are medicines that help people feel full faster, so they eat less and lose weight.

But quick weight loss can also shrink muscles, leading to weakness and a "flat bum" look. Scientists are now testing drugs like apitegromab to stop muscle loss while dieting.

Break it down

WHO: Adults in a study, scientists, and people using Ozempic or Wegovy

WHAT: A new drug called apitegromab helps keep muscles while losing fat

WHERE: In medical tests, currently only available by IV drip

WHY: Weight-loss medicines can sometimes make muscles shrink, and this drug aims to fix that

Why it matters

If you ever need medicine to be healthy, it's good to know that scientists are working to fix side effects so people can stay strong and feel good.

Test what you remember

1. What is a weird side effect of weight-loss drugs sometimes called?
 - (A) Big muscles
 - (B) Ozempic butt
 - (C) Sweaty palms
 - (D) Brain fog
2. What does the new drug apitegromab help with?
 - (A) Making you feel less hungry
 - (B) Keeping muscle while losing fat
 - (C) Cooling you down
 - (D) Fixing flat feet
3. How do you take apitegromab now?
 - (A) Pill
 - (B) By IV drip
 - (C) Inhaler
 - (D) Eye drops
4. What does the drug block?
 - (A) A virus
 - (B) A protein that breaks down muscle
 - (C) The feeling of hunger
 - (D) The need for sleep
5. What do doctors recommend to protect muscles while on these meds?
 - (A) Eat junk food
 - (B) Sleep all day
 - (C) Strength training like push-ups
 - (D) Avoid all exercise
6. How many adults were in the study?
 - (A) 50
 - (B) 102
 - (C) 200
 - (D) 10

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: B 3: B 4: B 5: C 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Hope for better health:** This drug could mean people lose dangerous fat but keep the muscle that helps them stay active and strong.
2. **Too soon to know:** The drug is only in tests and needs more studies to prove it's safe, so it's not a quick fix yet.
3. **Simple solutions first:** Doctors already say that eating well and doing push-ups can protect muscles without a new drug.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):